

QA Architecture Lab — Complete Build & CI/CD Playbook

Jenkins · Docker · k3d · Kubernetes · REST Assured

Repository	github.com/kanhaya/qa-architecture-lab
Pipeline	qa-k3d-pipeline @ http://localhost:8080
Audience	Senior SDETs & QA Architects
Status	End-to-end pipeline verified 

This document is a step-by-step record of **what was built**, **why each decision was made**, **what was achieved**, and **how to reproduce the full stack** from scratch.

PDF version: Run `./scripts/generate-playbook-pdf.sh` to regenerate `docs/QA-Architecture-Lab-Playbook.pdf`

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1. Overall Goal

Build a **production-style QA Architecture Lab** that demonstrates the full lifecycle of a cloud-native microservice:

Layer	Purpose
Application	A real REST API (Loan Service) that SDETs can test
Unit tests	Fast feedback on business logic
Docker	Package the app as a portable container image
Kubernetes (k3d)	Run 3 replicas with health probes and a NodePort service
API automation	REST Assured smoke/functional/negative/regression suites
CI/CD (Jenkins)	Quality gate (tests + static analysis + OpenAPI contract) → image → deploy → smoke tests

Target audience: Senior SDETs and QA Architects learning how modern teams ship and validate microservices.

Repository: github.com/kanhaya/qa-architecture-lab

2. What We Achieved

By the end of this lab you have:

-  A working **Loan Management REST API** with CRUD operations
-  **Unit and component tests** (`@WebMvcTest`) plus **OpenAPI contract tests** (in-process HTTP, no cluster)
-  **Static analysis** (Checkstyle, SpotBugs) bound to Maven `verify`
-  A **multi-stage Dockerfile** with a built-in health check
-  **Kubernetes manifests** (namespace, configmap, deployment, service)
-  A **k3d cluster** with an embedded Docker registry and NodePort access
-  **REST Assured API tests** (smoke, functional, negative, regression)
-  **Shell scripts** for cluster setup, deploy, validate, and dashboard
-  A **Jenkins pipeline** with a **Quality Gate before docker build** , then push, deploy, and cluster smoke tests
-  A **successful end-to-end build** from GitHub → Jenkins → k3d → passing tests

3. End-to-End Architecture



▼
JUnit / Surefire
Jenkins Report

Application internal architecture

HTTP Request



LoanController → LoanService → LoanRepository → InMemoryLoanRepository
(ConcurrentHashMap)

4. Phase 1 — Loan Service (Spring Boot)

What we built

A Maven multi-module project with a `loan-service` module:

```
loan-service/
├── src/main/java/com/qa/loanservice/
│   ├── controller/      LoanController.java
│   ├── service/         LoanService.java
│   ├── repository/      InMemoryLoanRepository.java
│   ├── model/           Loan, LoanStatus, DTOs
│   └── exception/       GlobalExceptionHandler, LoanNotFoundException
└── src/main/resources/
    ├── application.yml   (local - port 8081)
    ├── application-docker.yml (Docker - port 8080)
    └── application-kubernetes.yml (k8s - port 8080)
```

API endpoints

Method	Path	Description
GET	/api/loans	List all loans
GET	/api/loans/{id}	Get loan by ID
POST	/api/loans	Create loan (status: PENDING)
PUT	/api/loans/{id}/status	Update loan status
DELETE	/api/loans/{id}	Delete loan
GET	/actuator/health	Health check (used by k8s probes)
GET	/actuator/info	Application info

Seeded test data

ID	Customer	Amount	Status
101	Rahul	500,000	APPROVED
102	Amit	300,000	PENDING

Why port 8081 locally?

Jenkins runs on **port 8080**. To avoid conflicts during local development, the app defaults to **8081** on the host:

```
# application.yml
server:
  port: ${SERVER_PORT:8081}
```

Inside Docker and Kubernetes containers the app still listens on **8080**.

How to run locally

```
cd loan-service
mvn spring-boot:run

curl http://localhost:8081/actuator/health
curl http://localhost:8081/api/loans
```

5. Phase 2 — Unit Tests

What we built

JUnit 5 + Mockito tests inside `loan-service/src/test/` :

Test class	What it covers
<code>LoanServiceTest</code>	Business logic, create/update/delete
<code>InMemoryLoanRepositoryTest</code>	Data storage, seeded data
<code>LoanControllerTest</code>	HTTP layer with MockMvc
<code>GlobalExceptionHandlerTest</code>	Error responses (400, 404)
<code>LoanApiContractTest</code>	OpenAPI contract via REST Assured on <code>RANDOM_PORT</code>

Why separate from API tests?

Unit, MockMvc, and contract tests run **without Kubernetes** — `mvn -pl loan-service verify` is the Jenkins Quality Gate. Phase 5 REST Assured (`tests` module) still needs a deployed service.

How to run

```
mvn test -pl loan-service
# Full Quality Gate (tests + Checkstyle + SpotBugs + OpenAPI contract):
mvn -pl loan-service -am verify
```

6. Phase 3 — Docker Containerization

What we built

A **multi-stage Dockerfile** at the project root:

Stage	Base image	Purpose
Build	<code>eclipse-temurin:21-jdk-alpine</code>	Compile with Maven
Runtime	<code>eclipse-temurin:21-jre-alpine</code>	Run JAR as non-root user

Key design choices:

- **Non-root user** (`appuser`) for security
- **curl** installed for Docker `HEALTHCHECK`
- **Health check** hits `/actuator/health` every 30s
- Container listens on **port 8080** (`APP_ENV=docker` profile)

Why multi-stage?

Keeps the final image small (~200 MB vs ~600 MB with JDK) and follows production best practices.

How to build and run

```
mvn clean package -pl loan-service -am -DskipTests
docker build -t loan-service:1.0 .
docker run -p 8081:8080 -e APP_ENV=docker loan-service:1.0

curl http://localhost:8081/actuator/health
```

7. Phase 4 — Kubernetes (k3d) Deployment

What is k3d?

k3d runs a lightweight Kubernetes cluster (k3s) inside Docker containers on your local machine. It is ideal for learning and CI/CD labs without needing a cloud account.

What we built

Kubernetes manifests in `k8s/` :

File	Purpose
<code>namespace.yaml</code>	Isolates resources in <code>qa-lab</code> namespace
<code>configmap.yaml</code>	Sets <code>APP_ENV=kubernetes</code> , <code>SERVER_PORT=8080</code>
<code>deployment.yaml</code>	3 replicas, health probes, resource limits
<code>service.yaml</code>	NodePort 30080 → pod port 8080

Cluster setup script

`scripts/setup-k3d-cluster.sh` creates:

Component	Value
Cluster name	qa-lab (default) or qa-cluster (your setup)
Registry (host)	localhost:5001
Registry (in-cluster)	k3d-qa-registry:5000
NodePort	30080
Namespace	qa-lab

Why two registry URLs?

k3d exposes **one physical registry** under two names:

```

Your Mac / Docker daemon      Kubernetes pods
    |                          |
localhost:5001 —same registry— k3d-qa-registry:5000
(docker push)                (image pull)

```

Deployment highlights

```

# deployment.yaml
replicas: 3
readinessProbe: GET /actuator/health (port 8080)
livenessProbe:  GET /actuator/health (port 8080)
image: k3d-qa-registry:5000/loan-service:1.0

```

How to deploy manually

```

./scripts/setup-k3d-cluster.sh

docker build -t localhost:5001/loan-service:1.0 .
docker push localhost:5001/loan-service:1.0

kubectl apply -f k8s/
kubectl set image deployment/loan-service \
  loan-service=k3d-qa-registry:5000/loan-service:1.0 -n qa-lab

kubectl get pods -n qa-lab
curl http://localhost:30080/actuator/health
curl http://localhost:30080/api/loans

```

8. Phase 5 — API Automation (REST Assured)

What we built

A separate Maven module `tests/` with REST Assured + JUnit 5:

```
tests/src/test/java/com/qa/tests/
├── base/           BaseApiTest.java
├── clients/        LoanClient.java
├── models/         LoanResponse.java
├── utils/          TestConfig.java, TestDataFactory.java
├── tests/
│   ├── smoke/      SmokeTests.java      @Tag("smoke")
│   ├── functional/ FunctionalTests.java  @Tag("functional")
│   ├── negative/   NegativeTests.java    @Tag("negative")
│   └── regression/ RegressionSuite.java  (all tags)
```

Test URL auto-detection

`TestConfig.java` probes these URLs in order:

1. `http://localhost:8081` — local Spring Boot
2. `http://localhost:30080` — Kubernetes NodePort
3. Falls back to `8081` if nothing responds

It validates the response contains `"status":"UP"` so Jenkins on port 8080 is never mistaken for the Loan Service.

How to run

```
# Against local app
export BASE_URL=http://localhost:8081
mvn test -pl tests -Dgroups=smoke

# Against Kubernetes
export BASE_URL=http://localhost:30080
mvn test -pl tests -Dgroups=smoke
```

9. Phase 6 — Scripts Reference (Detailed)

The `scripts/` directory contains automation for cluster setup, deployment, validation, dashboard access, Jenkins integration, and documentation. Each script is **idempotent** where possible (safe to re-run).

Scripts overview map

```
scripts/
├── setup-k3d-cluster.sh      ← Foundation: create cluster + registry
├── deploy-and-test.sh       ← Main workflow: build → deploy → test
├── validate-deployment.sh   ← Health/replica checks (used by deploy-and-test)
├── start-lab.sh             ← Full lab: cluster + dashboard + status
├── setup-k8s-dashboard.sh   ← Install K8s Dashboard (foreground)
├── open-dashboard.sh        ← Open dashboard (background port-forward)
├── setup-jenkins-k3d-network.sh ← Connect Jenkins to k3d Docker network
├── configure-jenkins-kubeconfig.sh ← Runtime kubeconfig (used by Jenkinsfile)
├── export-jenkins-kubeconfig.sh ← Export kubeconfig for manual debugging
└── generate-playbook-pdf.sh ← Regenerate this playbook as PDF
```

9.1 `setup-k3d-cluster.sh` — Create k3d cluster and registry

Purpose: One-time (or repeatable) foundation for the entire lab. Creates a local Kubernetes cluster with an embedded Docker registry and applies all `k8s/` manifests.

Why needed: Without this, there is no cluster to deploy to and no registry for Kubernetes to pull images from. This is the **first script** you run when setting up the lab.

What it does step by step:

1. Checks `k3d` is installed
2. If cluster exists → skips creation, ensures NodePort `30080` is mapped
3. If cluster does not exist → creates cluster with:
 - Embedded registry at `localhost:5001` (in-cluster: `k3d-qa-registry:5000`)
 - NodePort mapping `30080:30080` for the Loan Service
 - 2 agent nodes (worker capacity)
4. Runs `kubectl apply -f k8s/` (namespace, configmap, deployment, service)

When to use:

```
./scripts/setup-k3d-cluster.sh
# Custom cluster name:
K3D_CLUSTER=qa-cluster ./scripts/setup-k3d-cluster.sh
```

Environment variables:

Variable	Default	Description
K3D_CLUSTER	qa-lab	k3d cluster name
REGISTRY_NAME	qa-registry	Registry name (becomes k3d-qa-registry)
REGISTRY_HOST_PORT	5001	Host port for docker push
NODE_PORT	30080	NodePort exposed on host
AGENTS	2	Number of k3d agent nodes

Output when successful:

```
Registry (host push): localhost:5001
Registry (in-cluster): k3d-qa-registry:5000
Service URL:         http://localhost:30080
Namespace:           qa-lab
```

9.2 `deploy-and-test.sh` — Full build, deploy, and test pipeline

Purpose: The **main orchestration script** — replicates locally what Jenkins does in CI. Builds the app, pushes the Docker image, deploys to Kubernetes, validates, and runs smoke tests.

Why needed: Provides a single command to verify the entire stack works without Jenkins. Useful for local development and debugging before pushing to CI.

What it does step by step:

Step	Action	Why
1	<code>mvnw clean package -pl loan-service -DskipTests</code>	Compile JAR without API tests (no server needed)
2	<code>docker build</code>	Package app into container image
3	<code>docker push localhost:5001/...</code>	Push to k3d registry so Kubernetes can pull
4	<code>kubectl apply -f k8s/ + kubectl set image</code>	Deploy/update with correct image tag
5	<code>kubectl rollout status</code>	Wait until all pods are ready
6	<code>validate-deployment.sh</code>	Verify replicas, pods, health endpoint
7	<code>mvnw test -pl tests -Dgroups=smoke</code>	Run REST Assured smoke tests

When to use:

```
./scripts/deploy-and-test.sh

# Custom image tag:
IMAGE_TAG=2.0 ./scripts/deploy-and-test.sh
```

Environment variables:

Variable	Default	Description
NAMESPACE	qa-lab	Kubernetes namespace
DEPLOYMENT	loan-service	Deployment name
BASE_URL	http://localhost:30080	API test target URL
TIMEOUT	180	Rollout and health timeout (seconds)
K3D_CLUSTER	qa-lab	k3d cluster name
REGISTRY	localhost:5001	Host registry for push
IMAGE_NAME	loan-service	Docker image name
IMAGE_TAG	1.0	Docker image tag

9.3 `validate-deployment.sh` — Post-deploy health and replica checks

Purpose: Gatekeeper script that confirms the deployment is **actually healthy** before running API tests. Called by `deploy-and-test.sh` and usable standalone.

Why needed: `kubectl rollout status` only confirms the rollout completed — it does not verify the health endpoint responds or all replicas are truly ready. This script adds that safety layer.

What it checks:

1. Deployment exists in namespace
2. `readyReplicas == desiredReplicas` (expects 3)
3. All pods are in `Running` state
4. All pods pass `Ready` condition
5. Service exists
6. Polls `GET /actuator/health` until `"status":"UP"` or timeout

When to use:

```
export BASE_URL=http://localhost:30080
./scripts/validate-deployment.sh
```

Fails fast with clear errors — prints pod status on failure for quick diagnosis.

9.4 `start-lab.sh` — Start the complete lab environment

Purpose: Brings up **everything** needed for hands-on learning: k3d cluster, Kubernetes Dashboard, port-forwards, and prints all access URLs and tokens.

Why needed: Convenience script for workshop/demo scenarios. One command to get cluster + dashboard + status summary.

What it does:

1. Runs `setup-k3d-cluster.sh`
2. Ensures NodePort `30080` is mapped
3. Installs Kubernetes Dashboard (if not present)
4. Creates `dashboard-admin` service account with cluster-admin role
5. Starts dashboard port-forward on `https://localhost:8443` (background)
6. Prints Loan Service URL, health URL, dashboard URL, and access token
7. Waits for health and dashboard to become reachable

When to use:

```
./scripts/start-lab.sh
# Then deploy the app:
./scripts/deploy-and-test.sh
```

9.5 `setup-k8s-dashboard.sh` — Install Kubernetes Dashboard

Purpose: Installs the official Kubernetes Dashboard and sets up admin access. Runs port-forward in the **foreground** (blocks terminal).

Why needed: Visual inspection of pods, services, deployments, and events — essential for learning Kubernetes and debugging `ImagePullBackOff`, probe failures, etc.

What it does:

1. Applies dashboard manifests from `kubernetes/dashboard` GitHub (v2.7.0)
2. Creates `dashboard-admin` ServiceAccount with `cluster-admin` ClusterRoleBinding
3. Waits for dashboard deployment to be ready
4. Generates a short-lived access token
5. Starts `kubectl port-forward` on `https://localhost:8443` (foreground)

When to use:

```
./scripts/setup-k8s-dashboard.sh
# Open https://localhost:8443 and paste the printed token
# Navigate to namespace: qa-lab
```

9.6 `open-dashboard.sh` — Open dashboard (background)

Purpose: Lightweight alternative to `setup-k8s-dashboard.sh` — starts port-forward in the **background** and prints the URL + token without blocking the terminal.

Why needed: When the dashboard is already installed and you just need to reconnect or get a fresh token.

When to use:

```
./scripts/open-dashboard.sh
# Dashboard at https://localhost:8443
```

9.7 `setup-jenkins-k3d-network.sh` — Connect Jenkins to k3d network

Purpose: Connects the Jenkins Docker container to the k3d cluster's Docker network so Jenkins can resolve `k3d-qa-registry`, reach the Kubernetes API, and hit the Loan Service NodePort.

Why needed: By default Jenkins runs on the `bridge` network and cannot resolve k3d hostnames (`k3d-qa-registry`, `k3d-qa-cluster-server-0`). Without this, registry checks, `kubectl`, and API tests fail inside Jenkins.

What it does:

1. Verifies Jenkins container exists
2. Verifies k3d network exists (`k3d-qa-cluster` or `k3d-<cluster-name>`)
3. Runs `docker network connect k3d-qa-cluster jenkins` (idempotent)

When to use (one-time after starting Jenkins):

```
JENKINS_CONTAINER=jenkins ./scripts/setup-jenkins-k3d-network.sh
```

After running, Jenkins can reach:

Target	URL
Registry	<code>k3d-qa-registry:5000</code>
Loan Service	<code>http://k3d-qa-cluster-server-0:30080</code>
Kubernetes API	<code>https://k3d-qa-cluster-serverlb:6443</code>

9.8 `configure-jenkins-kubeconfig.sh` — Generate kubeconfig at runtime

Purpose: Creates a valid kubeconfig **inside the Jenkins container** for `kubectl` commands. Used by the Jenkinsfile in Deploy and Wait stages.

Why needed: The host kubeconfig (`~/.kube/config`) uses `https://0.0.0.0:<port>` which fails inside Jenkins with TLS errors. This script fetches a fresh config from k3d and rewrites the API server to the Docker-network address.

What it does:

1. Runs `k3d kubeconfig get qa-cluster` via the k3d Docker image + Docker socket
2. Rewrites API server to `https://k3d-qa-cluster-serverlb:6443`
3. Sets `KUBECONFIG` environment variable to a temp file
4. Must be **sourced** (not executed) so `KUBECONFIG` persists in the shell

Used in Jenkinsfile as:

```
#!/usr/bin/env bash
source scripts/configure-jenkins-kubeconfig.sh
kubectl get nodes
```

Environment variables:

Variable	Default	Description
K3D_CLUSTER	qa-cluster	Cluster name
KUBE_SERVER	https://k3d-qa-cluster-serverlb:6443	API server URL
K3D_IMAGE	ghcr.io/k3d-io/k3d:5.8.3	k3d Docker image

9.9 `export-jenkins-kubeconfig.sh` — Export kubeconfig for manual use

Purpose: Generates a Jenkins-compatible kubeconfig file on your **Mac** for manual debugging or optional Jenkins credential upload.

Why needed: When you want to run `kubectl` from your Mac with the same API server URL Jenkins uses, or upload a pre-built kubeconfig to Jenkins credentials.

When to use:

```
./scripts/export-jenkins-kubeconfig.sh jenkins-kubeconfig.yaml
# Optional: upload to Jenkins → Manage Credentials → Secret file → ID: k3d-k
```

Note: The current Jenkinsfile generates kubeconfig at runtime and does **not** require this credential. This script is for manual debugging only.

9.10 generate-playbook-pdf.sh — Regenerate the PDF playbook

Purpose: Converts docs/BUILD-GUIDE.md into a styled PDF using md-to-pdf .

When to use:

```
./scripts/generate-playbook-pdf.sh
# Output: docs/QA-Architecture-Lab-Playbook.pdf
```

Scripts vs Jenkins pipeline — who does what?

Task	Local script	Jenkins pipeline
Create cluster	setup-k3d-cluster.sh	Manual one-time setup
Build JAR	deploy-and-test.sh	mvn clean package -DskipTests
Docker build/push	deploy-and-test.sh	Build Docker Image stage
kubectl deploy	deploy-and-test.sh	Deploy to Kubernetes stage
Wait for rollout	deploy-and-test.sh	Wait for Application stage
Validate health	validate-deployment.sh	(implicit in wait + tests)
API smoke tests	deploy-and-test.sh	Run REST Assured Tests stage
Connect Jenkins network	setup-jenkins-k3d-network.sh	Manual one-time setup
Kubeconfig for kubectl	configure-jenkins-kubeconfig.sh	Sourced in pipeline stages

One-command workflows

```
# First-time lab setup
./scripts/setup-k3d-cluster.sh
JENKINS_CONTAINER=jenkins ./scripts/setup-jenkins-k3d-network.sh

# Deploy and test locally (no Jenkins)
./scripts/deploy-and-test.sh

# Full lab with dashboard
./scripts/start-lab.sh
./scripts/deploy-and-test.sh

# Regenerate PDF playbook
./scripts/generate-playbook-pdf.sh
```

10. Phase 7 — Jenkins CI/CD Pipeline

Jenkins setup

Jenkins runs as a **Docker container** with:

- Port **8080** exposed (UI at <http://localhost:8080>)
- Docker socket mounted (`-v /var/run/docker.sock:/var/run/docker.sock`)
- Connected to the **k3d Docker network** (`k3d-qa-cluster`)

```
# One-time: connect Jenkins to k3d network
JENKINS_CONTAINER=jenkins ./scripts/setup-jenkins-k3d-network.sh
```

Pipeline job

- **Job name:** `qa-k3d-pipeline`
- **URL:** <http://localhost:8080/job/qa-k3d-pipeline/>
- **Source:** GitHub repo `kanhaya/qa-architecture-lab` (branch `main`)
- **Definition:** `Jenkinsfile` in repo root

Pipeline stages (in order)

#	Stage	What it does	Why
1	Checkout	Pulls code from GitHub	Always start from latest commit
2	Verify Environment	Checks docker, kubectl, mvn, registry, k3d API	Fail fast if infrastructure is broken
3	Quality Gate	<code>mvn -pl loan-service -am clean verify</code>	Unit tests, <code>@WebMvcTest</code> , OpenAPI contract (<code>RANDOM_PORT</code> — not <code>k3d / localhost:30080</code>), Checkstyle, and SpotBugs. Failure stops the pipeline; no image is built.
4	Build Docker Image	<code>docker build + docker push</code>	Package app, push to k3d registry
5	Deploy to Kubernetes	<code>kubectl apply + kubectl set image</code>	Roll out new image to 3 pods
6	Wait for Application	<code>kubectl rollout status</code>	Ensure pods are healthy before testing
7	Run REST Assured Tests	<code>mvn test -pl tests -Dgroups=smoke</code>	Validate deployed API automatically

The Quality Gate is the pre-image check: Checkstyle, SpotBugs, JUnit (`loan-service`), and OpenAPI contract tests against an in-process Spring Boot server (`RANDOM_PORT`). Cluster smoke tests (`tests` module) still run only after deploy.

Spec: [loan-service/src/main/resources/openapi/loan-service.yaml](#) . If a field or status code drifts from the spec, `verify` fails and Jenkins never builds an image.

The Dockerfile still uses `mvn ... -DskipTests` **inside the image build**. That is packaging of the same source Jenkins already verified — not a substitute for the Quality Gate.

Image tagging strategy

Each build tags the image with the Jenkins `BUILD_NUMBER` :

```
Build:    k3d-qa-registry:5000/loan-service:27
Push:     localhost:5001/loan-service:27        (same registry, host port)
Deploy:   kubectl set image ... loan-service:27
```

Key environment variables in Jenkinsfile

```
REGISTRY      = 'k3d-qa-registry:5000'    // in-cluster image name
HOST_REGISTRY = 'localhost:5001'          // docker push target
BASE_URL      = 'http://k3d-qa-cluster-server-0:30080' // API tests from Jenkins
NAMESPACE    = 'qa-lab'
K3D_CLUSTER   = 'qa-cluster'
```

Kubeconfig inside Jenkins

The pipeline generates kubeconfig at runtime via `scripts/configure-jenkins-kubeconfig.sh` :

1. Runs `k3d kubeconfig get qa-cluster` using the k3d Docker image
2. Rewrites API server to `https://k3d-qa-cluster-serverlb:6443`
3. Uses embedded TLS certificates (no manual credential upload needed)

Shell steps use `#!/usr/bin/env bash` because Jenkins defaults to `/bin/sh` (dash) which does not support `source` .

11. Port Map Reference

Service	Port	Who uses it
Jenkins UI	8080	You (browser) — not the Loan Service
Loan Service (local dev)	8081	<code>mvn spring-boot:run</code> on your Mac
Loan Service (container/k8s)	8080	Inside Docker pod
Loan Service (k8s NodePort)	30080	You + Jenkins API tests from Mac
k3d registry (host push)	5001	<code>docker push</code> from Jenkins/host
k3d registry (in-cluster)	5000	Kubernetes image pull
Kubernetes Dashboard	8443	https://localhost:8443
k3d API server (from Jenkins)	6443	<code>kubectl</code> inside Jenkins container

Quick health checks

```
# Loan Service on Kubernetes
curl http://localhost:30080/actuator/health

# Loan Service local dev
curl http://localhost:8081/actuator/health

# k3d registry
curl http://localhost:5001/v2/_catalog

# Jenkins (should NOT be used for API tests)
curl http://localhost:8080/
```

12. Problems Solved & Lessons Learned

Problem 1: Port 8080 conflict (Jenkins vs Loan Service)

Symptom: API tests returned `403 Forbidden` with `X-Jenkins` headers.

Cause: Tests pointed at `localhost:8080` which is Jenkins, not the Loan Service.

Fix: Local app uses port **8081**; Kubernetes tests use **30080**; Jenkins pipeline uses `k3d-qa-cluster-server-0:30080` .

Problem 2: `k3d-qa-registry:5000` — no such host

Symptom: `docker push k3d-qa-registry:5000` failed with DNS lookup error.

Cause: That hostname only exists on the k3d Docker network, not on the host where the Docker daemon runs.

Fix: Tag image as `k3d-qa-registry:5000/...` but push via `localhost:5001` (same physical registry).

Problem 3: kubeconfig TLS error inside Jenkins

Symptom: `x509: certificate signed by unknown authority`

Cause: Host kubeconfig uses `https://0.0.0.0:<port>` and/or file-path certificates that don't exist inside Jenkins.

Fix: Generate kubeconfig at runtime with `configure-jenkins-kubeconfig.sh` , pointing API server to `k3d-qa-cluster-serverlb:6443` .

Problem 4: `source: not found` in Jenkins

Symptom: `source: not found` when running kubeconfig script.

Cause: Jenkins `sh` step uses `/bin/sh` (dash), not bash.

Fix: Add `#!/usr/bin/env bash` as the first line of shell blocks that use `source` .

Problem 5: Cluster name mismatch

Symptom: Wrong hostnames in pipeline (`k3d-qa-lab` vs actual `qa-cluster`).

Fix: Aligned `K3D_CLUSTER` , `K3D_NETWORK` , `BASE_URL` , and `KUBE_SERVER` to match actual cluster name `qa-cluster` .

Problem 6: `mvn: not found` in Jenkins

Symptom: Pipeline fails at Maven stage with `mvn: not found` .

Cause: Jenkins container does not have Maven installed or not in PATH.

Fix: Install Maven inside Jenkins (or use a custom Jenkins image). Verify with `docker exec jenkins mvn --version` .

Problem 7: `kubectl: not found` in Jenkins

Symptom: Deploy stage fails — `kubectl` command not found.

Cause: Base Jenkins image does not include `kubectl`.

Fix: Install `kubectl` in the Jenkins container. Verify with `docker exec jenkins kubectl version --client` .

Problem 8: Namespace `qa-lab` not found

Symptom: `kubectl apply` fails — namespace does not exist.

Cause: Namespaced resources applied before namespace exists (race when applying all manifests at once).

Fix: Apply `k8s/namespace.yaml` first, or use `kubectl apply -f k8s/` which creates namespace before other resources. Re-run apply if race occurs.

Problem 9: REST Assured `Connection refused`

Symptom: Tests fail with connection refused before deploy completes.

Cause: Functional tests ran during `mvn clean test` before the API was deployed.

Fix: Jenkins **Quality Gate** (`mvn -pl loan-service -am verify`) runs unit/component/contract tests before the image. REST Assured in `tests` still runs only after deploy and rollout.

Key lesson: Maven proves the code. Kubernetes runs the image. REST Assured (`tests`) validates the **running** system.

Problem 10: `HTTP response to HTTPS client` (`ImagePullBackOff`)

Symptom: Pods stuck in `ImagePullBackOff`; events show `http: server gave HTTP response to HTTPS client`.

Cause: Registry serves plain HTTP but containerd tries HTTPS.

Fix: Create registry as part of k3d cluster setup:

```
k3d registry create qa-registry --port 5001
k3d cluster create qa-cluster --registry-use k3d-qa-registry:5000
```

Diagnostic: `kubectl describe pod <pod-name> -n qa-lab` — read the Events section.

Problem 11: Image tag mismatch

Symptom: Kubernetes pulls `loan-service:1.0` but Jenkins built `loan-service:27`.

Cause: Deployment manifest has a static tag; pipeline builds with `${BUILD_NUMBER}`.

Fix: `kubectl set image deployment/loan-service loan-service=k3d-qa-registry:5000/loan-service:${BUILD_NUMBER} -n qa-lab`

Diagnostic:

```
kubectl get pod -n qa-lab -o jsonpath='{.items[0].spec.containers[0].image}'
```

Problem 12: Registry `localhost:5001` timeout from Jenkins

Symptom: `curl localhost:5001` fails inside Jenkins container.

Cause: Inside Jenkins, `localhost` means the Jenkins container itself — not the Mac host.

Fix: For HTTP checks from Jenkins, use `k3d-qa-registry:5000`. For `docker push` via socket, use `localhost:5001` (Docker daemon on host).

13. Diagnostic Command Sheet

When something fails, identify **which layer** failed, then run diagnostics for that layer only.

Layer 1 — Docker / Jenkins

```
docker ps
docker inspect jenkins
docker logs jenkins --tail 50
docker exec jenkins docker --version
docker exec jenkins mvn --version
docker exec jenkins kubectl version --client
```

Layer 2 — Network / Registry

```
docker network inspect k3d-qa-cluster
docker exec jenkins getent hosts k3d-qa-registry
docker exec jenkins curl -sf http://k3d-qa-registry:5000/v2/_catalog
curl -sf http://localhost:5001/v2/_catalog
curl -sf http://localhost:5001/v2/loan-service/tags/list
```

Layer 3 — Kubernetes

```
kubectl get nodes
kubectl get ns
kubectl get all -n qa-lab
kubectl get pods -n qa-lab -o wide
kubectl describe pod <pod-name> -n qa-lab    # Most valuable for image failure
kubectl logs <pod-name> -n qa-lab
kubectl rollout status deployment/loan-service -n qa-lab
kubectl get svc loan-service -n qa-lab
```

Professional debugging pattern

```
Failure
↓
Identify the layer (build / registry / k8s / tests)
↓
Run the most direct diagnostic command
↓
Validate the hypothesis
↓
Change one thing
↓
Re-run pipeline
↓
Verify the next layer
```

14. Verification Checklist

Use this checklist every time you rebuild or debug the lab.

#	Check	Command	Expected result
1	Git repository	<code>git remote -v</code>	Points to <code>qa-architecture-lab</code>
2	Jenkins SCM	Build #N console	Checkout succeeds
3	Maven	<code>mvn --version</code> in Jenkins	Maven 3.9+
4	Docker	<code>docker --version</code> in Jenkins	Docker 20+
5	kubectl	<code>kubectl get nodes</code>	Node Ready
6	k3d API	<code>source scripts/configure-jenkins-kubeconfig.sh && kubectl get nodes</code>	Cluster reachable
7	Registry DNS	<code>docker exec jenkins getent hosts k3d-qa-registry</code>	Returns IP
8	Registry API	<code>curl http://k3d-qa-registry:5000/v2/_catalog</code> from Jenkins	JSON catalog
9	Quality Gate	Jenkins Quality Gate stage	<code>mvn verify</code> green (unit, contract, Checkstyle, SpotBugs)
10	Image push	<code>curl localhost:5001/v2/loan-service/tags/list</code>	Contains build tag
11	Namespace	<code>kubectl get ns qa-lab</code>	Exists
12	Deployment	<code>kubectl rollout status deployment/loan-service -n qa-lab</code>	Successfully rolled out
13	Pods	<code>kubectl get pods -n qa-lab</code>	3/3 Ready
14	Service	<code>kubectl get svc -n qa-lab</code>	NodePort 30080
15	Health	<code>curl http://localhost:30080/actuator/health</code>	<code>{"status":"UP"}</code>
16	API	<code>curl http://localhost:30080/api/loans</code>	JSON with loans 101, 102
17	REST Assured	Jenkins test stage	Smoke tests PASS
18	Reports	Jenkins build page	Surefire/JUnit results visible

15. How to Explain This Like a Pro

15.1 Sixty-second interview answer

"I built a local CI/CD environment where Jenkins runs in Docker and orchestrates the full test-deployment lifecycle. After checkout, a Quality Gate runs `mvn verify` on `loan-service`: unit tests, `MockMvc`, `OpenAPI` contract tests on a random port, `Checkstyle`, and `SpotBugs`. Only if that passes does Jenkins build and push a Docker image tagged with the build number to a local `k3d` registry. Kubernetes deploys that image with three replicas. The pipeline waits for rollout, then runs `REST Assured` smoke tests against the live `NodePort`. I separated in-process quality (no cluster) from black-box API tests (need a deployed service)."

15.2 Common interview questions

Q: Do you run tests before the image?

Yes. The Quality Gate is `mvn -pl loan-service -am verify`. That covers unit tests, `@WebMvcTest`, `OpenAPI` contract tests on `RANDOM_PORT`, `Checkstyle`, and `SpotBugs`. A failure never reaches `docker build`. Cluster `REST Assured` in the `tests` module still runs only after deploy, because those tests need a live URL.

Q: Why skip tests inside the Dockerfile?

Jenkins already verified the same source. The Docker `mvn ... -DskipTests` step is packaging, not a second test run. Contract and unit tests do not belong in the image build.

Q: Why Kubernetes Service?

Pods are ephemeral — their IPs change. The Service provides a stable network endpoint and load-balances traffic across ready pods.

Q: Why a registry?

The Docker image Jenkins builds must be available to the Kubernetes runtime. The registry is the contract between image creation and cluster deployment.

Q: Why build-number tags?

They make deployments traceable. I can identify exactly which Jenkins build produced the image running in Kubernetes. It avoids ambiguity from a mutable `latest` tag.

Q: How did you debug ImagePullBackOff?

I used `kubectl describe pod` and read the Events section. The event showed `HTTP response to HTTPS client`, which identified a registry protocol mismatch — not an application failure. I then verified registry reachability and reconfigured k3d registry integration.

Q: Why port 8081 locally but 30080 in Kubernetes?

Jenkins occupies port 8080 on my Mac. Local dev uses 8081 to avoid conflict. In Kubernetes, the Service exposes the app on NodePort 30080 while pods listen on 8080 internally.

16. Reproduce Everything From Scratch

Prerequisites

```
# Install on macOS  
brew install java maven docker k3d kubectl
```

Step 1 — Clone the repo

```
git clone https://github.com/kanhaya/qa-architecture-lab.git  
cd qa-architecture-lab
```

Step 2 — Run the Quality Gate

```
mvn -pl loan-service -am verify
```

Step 3 — Run locally

```
cd loan-service && mvn spring-boot:run  
# In another terminal:  
curl http://localhost:8081/api/loans
```

Step 4 — Create k3d cluster

```
./scripts/setup-k3d-cluster.sh  
# Or if using qa-cluster name:  
K3D_CLUSTER=qa-cluster k3d cluster create qa-cluster \  
  --registry-create qa-registry:0.0.0.0:5001 \  
  --port 30080:30080@server:0  
kubectl apply -f k8s/
```

Step 5 — Deploy to Kubernetes

```
./scripts/deploy-and-test.sh
```

Step 6 — Start Jenkins

```
docker run -d \  
  --name jenkins \  
  -p 8080:8080 -p 50000:50000 \  
  -v jenkins_home:/var/jenkins_home \  
  -v /var/run/docker.sock:/var/run/docker.sock \  
  jenkins/jenkins:lts  
  
# Connect to k3d network  
JENKINS_CONTAINER=jenkins ./scripts/setup-jenkins-k3d-network.sh
```

Install Maven, Docker CLI, and kubectl inside Jenkins (or use a custom Jenkins image).

Step 7 — Create Jenkins pipeline job

1. Open <http://localhost:8080>

2. New Item → Pipeline → name: `qa-k3d-pipeline`
3. Pipeline → Definition: **Pipeline script from SCM**
4. SCM: Git → URL: `https://github.com/kanhaya/qa-architecture-lab.git`
5. Branch: `main` → Script Path: `Jenkinsfile`
6. Save → **Build Now**

Step 8 — Verify successful build

See [Section 17](#).

17. Verify a Successful Build

In Jenkins

1. Open <http://localhost:8080/job/qa-k3d-pipeline/>
2. Latest build should show **green** (Success)
3. Check stages: all 7 stages completed
4. Console output should end with smoke tests passing

On your Mac

```
# Pods running (3 replicas)
kubectl get pods -n qa-lab

# Service reachable
curl http://localhost:30080/actuator/health
# Expected: {"status":"UP"}

curl http://localhost:30080/api/loans
# Expected: JSON array with loans 101 and 102

# Image in registry
curl http://localhost:5001/v2/_catalog
# Expected: {"repositories":["loan-service"]}
```

Expected pod output

NAME	READY	STATUS	RESTARTS	AGE
loan-service-xxxxxxxxxx-xxxxx	1/1	Running	0	2m
loan-service-xxxxxxxxxx-xxxxx	1/1	Running	0	2m
loan-service-xxxxxxxxxx-xxxxx	1/1	Running	0	2m

18. Production Maturity Path

The local lab is intentionally simple. The same architecture evolves into a production-grade platform:

Local lab	Production evolution
k3d local registry	GHCR, ECR, GCR, or enterprise registry with TLS
Build-number tags	Immutable image digests for provenance
Single Jenkins pipeline	Separate PR CI, build, publish, and deploy jobs
In-process Quality Gate (Checkstyle, SpotBugs, OpenAPI)	SonarQube quality gate, SAST, SCA, container scanning
Cluster smoke tests after deploy	Smoke → functional → regression → perf/security stages
Static k8s YAML	Helm or Kustomize per environment
Manual cluster	Ephemeral namespaces per PR/build
No observability	Prometheus, Grafana, centralized logs

Maturity ladder

```
Local learning lab
↓
Quality Gate (unit, contract, static analysis)
↓
Container registry
↓
Kubernetes deployment
↓
Cluster smoke / API tests
↓
Deeper security (SAST, SCA, container scan)
↓
Ephemeral test environments
↓
Promotion across environments (dev → QA → prod)
↓
Observability + automated diagnosis
```

Final takeaway

The most reusable lesson is the **dependency chain**:

```
source → quality gate → container image → registry → Kubernetes workload → Service
```

When a pipeline fails, locate the broken link in that chain and inspect that layer directly.

Summary

Phase	Built	Achieved
1 — Spring Boot	REST API + actuator	Runnable microservice
2 — Unit tests	JUnit/Mockito + OpenAPI contract	Fast CI feedback without a cluster
3 — Docker	Multi-stage image	Portable, health-checked container
4 — Kubernetes	k3d + manifests	3 replicas, NodePort, probes
5 — API tests	REST Assured suites	Automated API validation on the cluster
6 — Scripts	deploy-and-test.sh etc.	One-command operations
7 — Jenkins	Quality Gate → image → deploy → smoke	Bad commits never produce an image

Overall goal achieved: A complete, hands-on QA Architecture Lab demonstrating how a real team builds, containers, deploys to Kubernetes, and validates a microservice — with Jenkins automating the entire flow.

Next Steps (Roadmap)

Phase	Description
Resilience testing	Pod failure, scaling, rollback scenarios
Helm	Templatize Kubernetes manifests
Argo CD	GitOps-based deployment
Observability	Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry

See [README.md](#) for command reference and troubleshooting.